Cashless Hospitalization Guide

Document type: Cashless hospitalization guide

Plain-language guide compiled from the Policy Wordings and the IRDAI Master Circular.

1. What cashless means

Cashless Facility means the insurer pays the cost of treatment directly to a Network Provider, to the extent that pre-authorization is approved. You do not pay the covered bill amount at the hospital. Cashless treatment is available only at Network Hospitals. A Non-Network Provider is any hospital or provider not in the insurer's network. The latest list of network hospitals is on the insurer's website or available on request.

2. Domestic cashless: planned hospitalization

- Step 1: At least 48 hours before the planned hospitalization, you or your representative must inform the insurer and request pre-authorisation using the written form.
- Step 2: The insurer may ask for more information. If satisfied, it sends an authorisation letter to you or the Network Hospital.
- Step 3: At admission, show the authorisation letter, the ID card issued with the policy, and any other documents the insurer specified.
- Step 4: If the procedure was followed, you are not required to pay the amount the insurer is liable for under In-patient Hospitalization Treatment. The original bills and evidence of treatment stay with the Network Hospital.
- Pre-authorisation does not guarantee that all costs are covered. The insurer can review every claim and decides coverage under the policy terms and conditions.

3. Domestic cashless: emergency hospitalization

If treatment is on an emergency basis, you or your representative must inform the insurer in writing immediately, within 24 hours of hospitalization.

4. When cashless is denied or not used

If pre-authorisation is denied, if the hospital is not a Network Hospital, or if you prefer not to use cashless, follow the reimbursement procedure in the Claim Procedure Guide. Notice must be given within 48 hours of emergency hospitalization, or 48 hours before planned hospitalization, and documents submitted within 30 days of discharge.

5. International cover: pre-approval and treatment guarantee

- Certain benefits need pre-approval at least 72 hours before admission, or before availing the benefit, for planned treatment.
- Benefits needing pre-approval: In-patient Hospitalization Treatment, Day Care Procedures, Living Donor Medical Costs, Mental Illness Treatment, Accommodation for one parent staying with an insured child under 18 (Imperial Plus), and Palliative care (Imperial Plus).
- Download a Treatment Guarantee Form from the insurer's member website and send it at least five working days before treatment, by email, fax or post. If treatment is within 72 hours, details can be taken over the phone.
- The insurer then contacts the hospital to organise direct payment of your bill where possible.
- If you claim without pre-approval and the treatment is later found medically unnecessary, the insurer may decline the claim. If it is found medically necessary, the claim is processed on reasonable and customary expenses up to 80 percent of the coverage, subject to the policy terms.

6. International emergencies

- Get the emergency treatment you need first, then call the 24/7 International Helpline +353 1 630 1301 for advice and support.

- If you are hospitalised, you, your doctor, a dependant or a colleague must call the helpline within 48 hours of the emergency to inform the insurer. Treatment Guarantee Form details can be taken over the phone.
- Emergency treatment outside the area of cover requires treatment by a doctor to start within 24 hours of the emergency event, and is limited to 6 weeks per trip.

7. Covers that are cashless only

The following international covers are on a cashless basis only, and you must contact the insurer on +353 1 630 1301 at the first sign that the service is needed: Air Ambulance, Air Ambulance plus Medical Evacuation, Medical repatriation, and Repatriation of mortal remains. If these services are not organised by the insurer, it reserves the right to decline all costs incurred.

8. Regulatory timelines for cashless requests

The Policy Wordings do not state a turnaround time for cashless approval. The IRDAI Master Circular on Health Insurance Products (29 May 2024) requires insurers to decide a cashless authorization request within one hour of receiving it, and to give final authorization within three hours of the hospital's discharge request. See the IRDAI Consumer Guidance document for details.

9. Quick answers

Question	Answer
How early must I inform for a planned domestic cashless admission?	At least 48 hours before the planned hospitalization.
What if the domestic admission is an emergency?	Inform the insurer in writing immediately, within 24 hours of hospitalization.
Is cashless available at any hospital?	No. Only at Network Hospitals.
Does pre-authorisation guarantee full payment?	No. Coverage is decided under the policy terms and conditions.
How early is pre-approval needed for planned international treatment?	At least 72 hours before admission; the Treatment Guarantee Form should be sent at least five working days before treatment.
What is the international helpline?	+353 1 630 1301, available 24/7.

Source: Section E clauses 44 and 45 and Section C Part B of the Policy Wordings (UIN BAJHLIP23020V012223); Part 8 refers to the IRDAI Master Circular on Health Insurance Products dated 29 May 2024.